

Osaid Khan

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Dear Hiring Team,

It is with great pleasure that I submit my candidacy for the **Software Engineer** role on the Games team at **The New York Times**. I bring over three years of professional experience building user-facing features in large-scale web applications with React and TypeScript, along with a strong academic foundation as a Master of Science in Computer Science graduate from Pace University, NY — and I am excited by the mission of building fun, thoughtful, and rewarding play into people's daily lives.

Through my experience across two engineering roles, I have built and shipped production-grade, user-facing features that directly reflect **the frontend depth and full-lifecycle ownership this position demands**. As a Software Engineer at Sperse, I built a React and TypeScript visual workflow platform with React Flow, delivering accessible, responsive interfaces and reusable shared components with modern HTML/CSS that let users create, run, and manage agentic swarms across large-scale web applications. I instrumented features for observability and experimentation — including A/B testing — wiring GitHub Actions CI/CD pipelines with OpenTelemetry trace-based evals that define success metrics and flag latency, accuracy, and safety regressions before release. I participated in the full development lifecycle from technical design through implementation, code review, testing, and release across Node.js web applications and Go-based APIs on the AWS cloud platform, and I supported an on-call rotation, debugging and resolving production issues with logs, metrics, and monitoring — exactly the kind of end-to-end, experiment-driven work of optimizing conversion surfaces and driving players toward higher-value experiences that the CASH squad does. Prior to Sperse, as a Software Engineer at Qualitest, I optimized PostgreSQL with window functions, materialized views, and indexes to improve web performance, then exposed the data through interactive React visualizations with modern HTML/CSS and JavaScript for business stakeholders. I also designed a cloud-agnostic Storage Service in Java and Spring Boot handling server-side operations across Google Cloud Storage, S3, and MinIO, and orchestrated long-running jobs with AWS Step Functions across 100K+ weekly executions while authoring detailed technical documentation of tradeoffs and rationale. Together, these roles have prepared me to **develop and test entry points across NYT's web and mobile surfaces, collaborate with partner teams, and participate fully in technical design, code review, and release**.

I have always been passionate about **independent journalism and making work so good it's worth paying for**, and I envision myself contributing my talent to the furthering of **the Times' mission to seek the truth and help people understand the world**. I would love to discuss my interest in this position with your team and can be reached at +1 (945) 304-5781 or khanosaid726@gmail.com. Thank you for your time and consideration, I look forward to connecting!

Sincerely,
Osaid Khan